



Fraud Awareness Summary

One-briefing digest of the Shield Force programme: threats, defences and drills.

THREAT PICTURE

Financial fraud against defence personnel and families now runs across every channel: UPI collect requests, QR reversals, fake army buyer profiles, loan and investment apps, impersonation of CDA / record offices, welfare fund charity fraud, honey-trap led extortion and 'digital arrest' intimidation. Attackers study military life - pay days, postings, retirement dates - and script their calls around it.

EIGHT SCAM FAMILIES EVERY SOLDIER SHOULD KNOW

1. Fake UPI / QR payment reversal fraud on resale platforms.
2. OTP and KYC phishing (bank, SIM, Aadhaar, SPARSH pretexts).
3. Investment and crypto Ponzi pitches with 'guaranteed' returns.
4. Impersonation of officers for advance-fee deals (vehicles, canteen goods).
5. Pension, arrears and insurance fraud against veterans and widows.
6. Fake welfare fund and martyr-charity donation drives.
7. Loan app harassment and identity theft from leaked documents.
8. Digital arrest / fake police video-call extortion.

CORE DEFENCES

- Never share OTP, PIN, CVV or passwords - with anyone, in any uniform.
- Verify identities through official numbers you look up yourself.
- Refuse urgency: real institutions give you time and paper trails.
- Separate accounts: one exposed account with small balance for UPI, salary and savings kept insulated.
- Report every attempt on 1930 / cybercrime.gov.in - attempts are intelligence.

GOLDEN WINDOW

First 60 minutes after a fraudulent transfer: call 1930, report on cybercrime.gov.in, freeze the channel with your bank. Acting inside this window gives the best chance of holding funds before they are layered across mule accounts.

UNIT-LEVEL DRILL

1. Quarterly 30-minute fraud briefing for families (use Shield Force modules).
2. Display the Quick Red-Flag Checklist at CSD canteens and unit gates.
3. Nominate a unit cyber-buddy to help file 1930 / NCRP complaints fast.
4. De-stigmatise reporting: brief that concealment, not the con, causes the loss.